problem, developing countries such as India believed that they were being asked to bear the costs for greenhouse gas emissions by developed countries. Meanwhile, developed countries were reluctant to part with financing or technology to mitigate emissions in the developing world. Initial national commitments resulted in the Kyoto Protocol in the 1990s, which enshrined the principle of 'common but differentiated responsibilities' between developed and developing countries. After a near breakdown of talks on a successor mechanism at the Copenhagen Climate Summit in 2009, the United States, China, India, Brazil, and South Africa negotiated an agreement that kept alive the prospect of a binding accord to succeed the Kyoto Protocol. The 2015 Paris Summit proved more successful, with each country agreeing to meet voluntary targets or 'nationally determined contributions' (NDCs). Subsequent summits of the Conference of Parties (COP) of the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCC) have built further on these developments. Paris is not the only significant international climate agreement: the Montreal Protocol and its subsequent revisions have made remarkable progress in eliminating halogenated hydrocarbons that were depleting the ozone layer.

Cyber space is in some ways a partial global common. Servers, routers, cables, and satellite communication systems are owned by private companies or governments and are subject to national laws. However, it is often difficult to ascribe responsibility, and many aspects of cyber space remain ungoverned or under-governed. While not subject to an international treaty, Internet governance has to date benefited from a 'multi-stakeholder' model that also involves non-governmental actors. This can be contrasted with a multilateral model in which only sovereign states govern the Internet. But in the absence of a global treaty and fast-changing technologies, the future of governance in cyber space will have to be continuously renegotiated.

A third function of multilateral institutions is to govern economic and social interactions across borders. This can extend potentially to such issues as trade, lending, monetary policy, development, and standards. Participating countries benefit by increasing market access, harmonizing